

Your review report

Manuscript

Exploring the causal relationship between gut microbiota, circulating inflammatory proteins, and colorectal neuroendocrine tumors: A Mendelian randomization study

Feedback for the author(s)

Review file(s)

No files added.

Comments to the author(s)

1. The study uses three different data sources for microbiota, circulating inflammatory proteins, and colorectal neuroendocrine tumors , respectively. How do you ensure that all variants in all datasets are associated with the exposure in the same direction?
2. How confident are you for the SNPs you selected to be instrumental variables given little is known about the genetics in IM and NETs ?
3. Who performed all the statistical analysis? Is there a statistician in your team for such complicated analysis? If not, I recommend all the stats should be checked by a statistician.

Confidential feedback for the Editor

Your recommendation

• *Return for major revisions*

Is the study design appropriate to answer the research question (including the use of appropriate controls), and are the conclusions supported by the evidence presented?

- *No, but these points can be addressed with revisions*

Are the methods sufficiently described to allow the study to be repeated?

- *No, but these points can be addressed with revisions*

Is the use of statistics and treatment of uncertainties appropriate?

- *I am not able to assess this*

Comments

I suggest all the results should be checked by a statistician.

Has guidance been provided on how overstated claims should be rewritten?

- *No , I have not*

Is the presentation of the work clear?

- *No, it needs some language corrections before being published*

Are the images in this manuscript (including electrophoretic gels and blots) free from apparent manipulation?

- *I am not able to assess this*

Confidential comments to the Editor